

Test 1 answer key

Reading and Use of English

Part 1

1 A 2 B 3 D 4 C 5 B 6 B 7 A 8 C



Answer key
with extra
explanations in
Resource Bank

Part 2

9 come 10 well 11 which 12 any 13 into 14 with
15 too 16 how

Part 3

17 criticising / criticizing 18 championships 19 energetic 20 competitors
21 intellectual 22 unwillingness 23 admiration 24 strength

Part 4

25 to get | USED to
OR: to become | USED to
26 the boy | WHOSE sister
27 keep an/your EYE | on
28 was | NOT to bring
29 as SOON as | we arrive/are/'re
30 far as | I am/'m CONCERNED

Part 5

31 D 32 A 33 C 34 D 35 C 36 B

Part 6

37 F 38 C 39 A 40 E 41 G 42 D

Part 7

43 D 44 B 45 D 46 A 47 C 48 A 49 D 50 C 51 A 52 B

Test 1 answer key

Listening

Part 1

1 B 2 A 3 B 4 C 5 B 6 B 7 B 8 A



Answer key
with extra
explanations in
Resource Bank

Part 2

9 Brazil 10 creatures 11 goat 12 novels 13 national park
14 zebras 15 behaviour/behavior 16 camping
17 bird(-)song / birds' song 18 (special) trips

Part 3

19 G 20 C 21 D 22 E 23 A

Part 4

24 B 25 A 26 A 27 C 28 C 29 A 30 C

Audioscript

Test One.

This is the B2 First for Schools Listening test.

I'm going to give you the instructions for this test. I'll introduce each part of the test and give you time to look at the questions. At the start of each piece you'll hear this sound:

tone

You will hear each piece twice.

Remember, while you are listening, write your answers on the question paper. You'll have five minutes at the end of the test to copy your answers onto the separate answer sheet.

There will now be a pause. Please ask any questions now, because you must not speak during the test.

[pause]

Now open your question paper and look at Part One.

[pause]

PART 1

You will hear people talking in eight different situations. For questions 1 to 8, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

Question 1

You hear a boy talking about a visit to an art gallery.

[pause]

tone

Boy: My parents took me along to our local art gallery the other day. I'm studying modern art at school this term, and so I already felt pretty informed and clued up about the subject. I wondered whether I'd actually pick up some more information that might be useful, and I was a bit reluctant to go! In the end they encouraged me to wander off without them and just look at what I thought was interesting, which suited everyone. Usually Dad gets one of those audio tours for me to listen to, and then it's all too much – you know, all those dates and facts, that sort of thing gives me a headache.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 2

You hear a woman talking about taking part in a physical challenge for a television programme.

[pause]

tone

Interviewer: So tell us about this challenge you did.

Woman: Well, it involved kayaking along the Amazon, and everything we did was filmed for television. Luckily the production team were my friends so it was like being on just the best adventure together. Looking back the way we did it was pretty mad – we hadn't researched properly what the weather might be like, and we discovered it could be very changeable. We were also pretty bad at sticking to a realistic schedule so we were there for two weeks more than we should've been. On the plus side we saw amazing wildlife every day, and the film we ended up making was spectacular.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Test 1 answer key

- Question 3 *You hear two students talking about a biology lesson they have just had about feeling dizzy.*
- [pause]
tone
- Boy: When the teacher talked about what makes people feel dizzy – that was funny, wasn't it?
- Girl: Well, it's all to do with how the inner ear controls balance – like in the film she showed about dancers and why they don't fall down when they spin around.
- Boy: They use a technique I just didn't understand at first – it was called spotting, wasn't it? Fixing their eyes on one place in the room when they're turning fast. I just couldn't get how that worked, until I saw the film.
- Girl: The others found it amusing, though, which was a shame, because it demonstrated a scientific principle very clearly.
- Boy: It was quite funny though, you must admit!
- [pause]
tone
[The recording is repeated.]
[pause]

- Question 4 *You hear a girl talking about a novel she has just read.*
- [pause]
tone
- Girl: Have you read *Jake's Journey* yet? I enjoyed it, actually, although I wasn't really expecting to. I mean, it's over 600 pages so it isn't really the sort of novel I'd normally tackle – I find it hard to focus for that long. Once I'd started, though, I found myself racing through it, and every page was vital to the storyline! I just found now and again, the writer gave the motivation behind a character's actions, which I could've worked out for myself. It was as though I wasn't capable – a bit irritating. As for the setting, though, there were so many details about the surrounding countryside, I could picture myself right there.
- [pause]
tone
[The recording is repeated.]
[pause]

Question 5. You hear two friends discussing a television programme about an expedition in the Antarctic.

[pause]

tone

Boy: That group that skied to the South Pole – the programme started with so much stuff about their lives – unnecessary I thought – I mean who were they?

Girl: Just ordinary people who wanted to prove they're up for challenges. But there was loads about them collecting data on the effects of extreme temperatures – it could have been interesting but they overdid that really.

Boy: The technical stuff did go on a bit. And the description of the cold was hard to take – I was wiggling my toes to make sure they were still there!

Girl: One girl's hair froze and broke – she had to have it all cut off afterwards. That sounded dreadful!

Boy: Made it more interesting, though!

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 6 You hear a teenager talking about his trip to the theatre.

[pause]

tone

Boy: My parents have always loved going to see plays at the theatre, so it was inevitable I'd be dragged along too. I'd always gone to football on Saturdays, though, so imagine how I felt having to go with my sister to an afternoon performance instead! Anyway, we hadn't booked, and when we arrived at the theatre, we discovered the show had sold out – apart from two seats at the front, which we got quite cheaply! It was a musical, something I wouldn't have sat through in a million years ... it turned out to be a real eye-opener. I've now become hooked on drama, rather than football, which I thought I'd never give up!

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Test 1 answer key

Question 7

You hear the introduction to a programme about a girl called Maria who is very good at computing.

[pause]

tone

Woman: Maria Tennant is a 19-year-old American girl who's already achieving success as a computer programmer. Maria got into programming early, thanks to an interest in gaming ... and her mother's encouragement. Maria loved video games even when she was very young. Her mum would watch her rush home from school, speed through her homework, then jump onto her favourite computer game. Of course, she wasn't too thrilled seeing her daughter sitting for hours in front of a screen, but decided that she should find a way to take advantage of her enthusiasm. Maria's mum suggested that, instead of playing games, Maria should learn how to create them herself. The rest, as they say, is history.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 8

You hear a boy telling a friend about a student exchange trip he went on.

[pause]

tone

Girl: How was your exchange trip to France?

Boy: Fine! I learnt some French, and there were different activities.

Girl: Tom said you visited a chocolate factory!

Boy: Yeah, he loved that. And we went into school too. It was all great actually. I surprised myself by coping with being away from home – I wasn't sure I was ready to put myself through that. But before you go on a trip like that, you should think about what you want to get out of it – are you going just to have fun or to find out more about the place and the people. I'm wondering whether I actually went for the right reasons.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part One.

Now turn to Part Two.

PART 2

You will hear a woman called Anita Farrant talking about her work as a conservationist, protecting wildlife. For questions 9 to 18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

You now have forty-five seconds to look at Part Two.

[pause]

tone

I'm Anita Farrant and I'm going to talk about my work as a conservationist: working with wildlife to make sure it's protected. Today I'm answering questions texted in by listeners. First Lynne, who's fourteen, asks where I grew up. Well, my parents were from Canada but they moved to Japan before I was born because of my Dad's work. My mum was a scientist and often visited Brazil for research. My parents eventually decided to live there permanently so, soon after I was born, we all went there and that's where I spent my childhood.

Now Max wants to know if I lived in the countryside when I was young. Yes – in a really wild place with mountains close by where my parents sometimes took me for long walks. We lived near the sea and me and a friend spent hours on the beach with our fishing nets searching for creatures in the small pools there.

Sara asks if I had pets when I was growing up. Well I was desperate to have a dog, but my parents didn't like the idea. They kept chickens for eggs and me and Dad once found an injured bird, and I looked after that for a few days until it recovered. We also had a goat – it lived in the garden, and that became mine because they didn't really bother with it.

Aron wants to know how I got the idea of becoming a conservationist. Well, I obviously did Biology at school and enjoyed the lessons – the textbooks seemed rather dull though. But a friend lent me some novels about a wildlife expert, and that made me interested in being one too. After that, I started reading nature magazines, which I actually learnt a lot from.

Rebecca asks what my first job was. I went to university in Sydney, Australia and wanted to stay there after my course finished. Some friends ended up working in the zoo there which was fantastic, they said. I was interested in animals in the wild though, and found work in a national park – which involved improving the habitat for crocodiles. It was amazing but I wanted experience with other wildlife so eventually I left and found work with a rainforest project.

Francesca wonders what my most memorable job was. That was some work I did in South Africa on studying endangered species. Various animals are close to becoming extinct there, black rhinos for example. I was monitoring zebras – you may not realise that these animals are at risk. Leopards are another endangered species and I'd love to do something to help them too.

Pavel asks what I find most interesting about wild animals. Well, I've collected a lot of data about the populations of different endangered species in areas where I've worked, but what I really find fascinating is observing the behaviour of different species – though learning about their health and diet is obviously very important too.

Katy wonders why I started my wildlife activity centre in England. Well, I married an English man and we had this idea of giving people from cities the opportunity to enjoy the countryside. We run various activities – canoeing's something we've started recently that's been successful with families with young children, tree-climbing's growing in popularity, but camping's what appeals to teenagers more than anything else.

Test 1 answer key

Leo asks how we help young children to find out more about wildlife. Well, we have days out to teach them the names of flowers and plants. Getting them to correctly identify birdsong is a new idea we've had — doing that will be a challenge but a great experience. We currently run what we call the 'animal detective club' – kids examine animal footprints and work out which animals made them – that's fun for everyone.

Zoe thinks she'd like to be a conservationist herself and asks if I have any advice for her. There are courses you can do in the school holidays to teach you about this, Zoe – you probably won't want to spend your holidays studying, though. You can find special trips for students interested in conservation, and they're very worthwhile. Of course work experience is useful but hard to get, so it's not really an option. But if you're interested, then

[pause]

Now you will hear Part Two again.

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part Two.

Now turn to Part Three.

PART 3

You will hear five extracts in which teenagers are talking about taking photos on their phones. For questions 19 to 23, choose from the list (A to H) the advice which each speaker gives. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

You now have thirty seconds to look at Part Three.

[pause]

tone

Speaker 1

I don't actually know anyone who uses a proper camera any more – I take tons of photos on my mobile phone though, and so do my friends. I used to just take anything, it didn't matter what the subject was or what else was around it – I thought it'd be great to have a record of everything I did. My photos didn't turn out well though. You couldn't see any details in them at all, nor what colour things were because everything was so badly lit. I started to think how I could improve and I'd definitely recommend looking into all the functions on the phone. I did that and my pictures really are better these days.

[pause]

Speaker 2

I've been taking photos for as long as I can remember – since I got my phone actually. At first I played around with all the apps to see what I could achieve – and I took photos of a huge variety of things, but especially people. What I didn't think about was where they were – there was often something else in the shot I didn't want there. So making sure there's nothing too distracting behind your subject is really important. Nowadays I tend to concentrate on close-ups of my family and friends indoors – it's often hard to get the light contrast right but I find it an interesting challenge.

[pause]

Speaker 3

I love using the camera on my phone, but because it's got so many great settings, it's very tempting to just click away, and I end up with hundreds of photos that are pretty average. I've realised it's worth trying to work out how a picture will come across when you see it on a screen or print-out. What works for me is imagining a border around what I'm taking the photo of, and then, within that, I think about the arrangement of things – is there a balance between the red in one corner and the blue in another, or between the street lamp on one side and the light from the house window on the other?

[pause]

Speaker 4

I like to think about what effect I want to create when I'm taking a photo. I don't just want to rely on editing later on, you know, messing around getting the contrast and shade and colour right, and changing the light exposure. That's not real photography for me. When you're starting out it pays to browse photo websites to see what's out there – then think about how you can improve your photos by taking on board different ideas and techniques. And you'll end up deleting far fewer photos and discover you're able to take photos that really do look very professional.

[pause]

Test 1 answer key

Speaker 5

[pause]

There's lots you can do with the camera on your phone – there are so many different colours and effects to choose from. I actually think it's better to photograph what's actually there, though. Recently I've been trying some night-time shots. It's a totally different skill, taking photos in the dark, without the help of a flash to light things up. But I've got some fantastic pictures of the night sky. It changes according to the weather conditions – you can get amazing results. Not getting stuck on one thing helps keep your interest and develops your skills, I think. So, now I'm trying to take people's faces when they're concentrating on work, and not aware I'm there.

[pause]

Now you will hear Part Three again.

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part Three.

Now turn to Part Four.

PART 4

You will hear an interview with a man called Joe Newton, who dives off high places in a competitive sport known as cliff diving. For questions 24 to 30, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

You now have one minute to look at Part Four.

[pause]

tone

Interviewer: The eighth floor of a building is about twenty-seven metres above the ground, which is the height of a cliff dive. Today, top cliff diver Joe Newton will answer listeners' questions. Welcome Joe. Now, Alex, who's fourteen, asks how you first got into diving.

Joe: I was a competitive swimmer as a kid, and when I went training, I used to see divers practising in the pool next to ours. They'd do unbelievable spins and backflips – I thought they were awesome. It all looked rather dangerous too, though – I couldn't really imagine myself doing it. I eventually got chatting to a couple of divers. They encouraged me to have a go, taught me a few basics, and made me feel I'd get more out of diving than swimming, and that's what did it.

Interviewer: Katie, who's thirteen, asks why you decided to change from diving in a pool to cliff diving.

Joe: I did pool diving for eight years. I made the national team and even dived in the Olympics. Once I'd left school, when I wasn't training for events, I used to get the opportunity to perform in diving shows in theme parks – it meant I got to travel and the pay was pretty attractive too. There were cliff divers in those shows, and, from talking to them, I realised my chances of winning medals doing that would be higher. So, I changed.

Interviewer: Sam wants to know what the biggest difference between normal diving and cliff diving is.

Joe: Cliff dives are from a height of twenty-seven metres, rather than five or ten, and we're moving at about eighty-five kilometres an hour when we reach the water. That's super-quick and there are dangers involved. Getting used to that takes a while, but how you hit the surface of the sea or river is the trickiest thing to adjust to – it's feet-first because the impact could cause injury otherwise.

Interviewer: Now, Sarah, who's sixteen, asks what your training involves.

Joe: Apart from strength and fitness, it's about the hours needed to create and perfect different dives. Ideally, I'd always have someone giving me advice, but professional instructors tend to stay away from cliff diving, so on the whole, I have to work out everything myself. There aren't any cliffs near where I live, so, because I train from a ten-metre board, I have to practise different parts of the dive separately and only put them together in competitions. Actually, it'd be too much for my body if I was always diving off cliffs.

Interviewer: Zac asks how you got on in your most recent competition.

Joe: I came third overall. The wind was strong and the sea was choppy that day, it was a bit alarming because the weather really wasn't suitable for diving. Also, I tried out a new, difficult dive, which I actually managed to pull off, and I feel I was unfairly penalised for a small mistake. I mentioned this in a TV interview afterwards, and, unfortunately, I came across as a bad loser – I know I don't always express myself very well, I'm afraid.

Test 1 answer key

Interviewer: Here's Sophia's question: What goes through your mind during a dive?

Joe: Although I'm pretty experienced now, in the lead-up to a dive, my stomach still turns over and my head buzzes. Once I'm on the board, though, that disappears, and I don't concern myself with whether my legs or hands are in the right place – I've practised the dives so often they just happen. I don't see or hear anything in the few seconds it takes to hit the surface. Then it's back to normal.

Interviewer: Robbie asks what you think the future holds for cliff diving.

Joe: In the last ten years, cliff diving's seen more competitions and larger crowds. There were 60,000 spectators at one recent event, and I can't see why the trend won't continue. The dives will have to get more difficult technically too, otherwise people will lose interest, though twenty-seven metres is about the limit in terms of height – the body can't cope with anything above that.

Interviewer: OK, Joe. Thanks very much for answering those questions.

[pause]

Now you will hear Part Four again.

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part Four.

There will now be a pause of five minutes for you to copy your answers onto the separate answer sheet. Be sure to follow the numbering of all the questions. I'll remind you when there's one minute left, so that you're sure to finish in time.

[pause – four minutes]

You have one more minute left.

[pause – one minute]

That's the end of the test. Please stop now. Your supervisor will now collect all the question papers and answer sheets.